

The future of philosophy



What is the place of philosophy in a world so dominated by science and technology? Many philosophical explanations of the world have been superseded by scientific theories, and the areas of metaphysics, epistemology and logic have been explored apparently to their limits. Twenty-first-century philosophers have become more concerned with moral and political questions, and the trend to practical applications seems set to continue. But in philosophy there are, more often than not, no definitive answers. Many problems have still not been satisfactorily tackled, and some of our assumptions may yet be proved entirely wrong. It may be that even

science, philosophy's brilliant offspring, could reveal fundamental flaws. Philosophers are still unravelling the implications of their predecessors' ideas and building on their legacy, but the recent revival in philosophy has attracted a new generation of thinkers. If history is any guide, there is no doubt that another Socrates, Descartes, Hume or Kant will emerge from among them with a revolutionary new idea to change forever the way we think.